

It's the Genealogy, STUPID!

At the rate political dynasties are proliferating, the day is not far when it will be difficult to find a minister or MP whose father hasn't been there before

— By **PRABHU CHAWLA**

Try not to become a man of success but rather try to become a man of value —Albert Einstein

Someone once said that if you want to be right about India, it pays to be a pessimist. So, amidst all the hoopla about a resurgent India, it's wise to be pessimistic about the most defining aspect of India Tomorrow: leadership. In that epochal midnight of 1947, what brightened the national mind was the visionary aura of those leaders whom any country would have proudly laid claim to: Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru,

Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, Rafi Ahmed Kidwai... all great men with iron in their soul, and whose successes were accentuated by the values they upheld. Without exception, they were all born into immense wealth; many were educated abroad and therefore "elitist". Yet all of them went through the grind and made their way up and earned both acceptability and respectability. They created institutions that have stood the test of time and divisive politics. Nehru was the first moderniser

and nation builder; Patel redrew the country's map with the merger of states; the Maulana laid emphasis on building a sound educational system, and Kidwai ushered in the green revolution. In the states too, it was an embarrassment of riches: Dwarka Prasad Mishra, Biju Patnaik, Mohan Lal Sukhadia, Morarji Desai, Pratap Singh Kairon, Chandra Bhan Gupta who stood up to the giants in Delhi. Even the opposition space was crowded with such grandees as S.A. Dange, Shyama Prasad Mukherjee, Ram

